

WOLGAWURZELN

GENEALOGY OF THE GERMANS FROM RUSSIA



SAMPLE DOCUMENT

THE FAMILIES
SCHÄFER · HOFFMANN
AND
BAUER · WAGNER

A family history from the Wetterau, Lorraine, Württemberg and
Prussia via the Volga, the Black Sea and Bessarabia to Kazakhstan and
southwest Germany

Büdingen · Norka · Mariental · Grossliebental · Tarutino · Karaganda · Ludwigsburg

1766 to the present

Prepared for the Schäfer family

September 2026

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

SOURCES AND METHOD

Four surnames, four colonies, three paths of persecution and two arrivals in Germany. This report brings together what the sources yield on the Schäfer, Hoffmann, Bauer and Wagner lines, and states at every point how certain a statement is.

The report rests on three kinds of sources. First the family's documents: birth and marriage certificates, the naturalization notice of 1944, recollections and photographs for all four lines.¹ Second the published sources on the colonies: first settlers lists, gazetteers and local histories, which supply founding dates, the settlers' origins and population figures.^{2 4 7 9 10} Third the record of persecution: the decree of 28 August 1941, the resolutions on the labor army, the resettlements of 1940 and 1944 and the decrees on rehabilitation.^{11 12 14 15 16}

Every key statement carries a source number; the list of sources is at the end. The findings at the close of each chapter grade the statements in three steps: **documented**, when a source supports it; **probable**, when evidence points to it but proof is missing; **open**, when the question can only be settled with a record not yet at hand. Nothing is embellished.

THE FOUR LINES AT A GLANCE

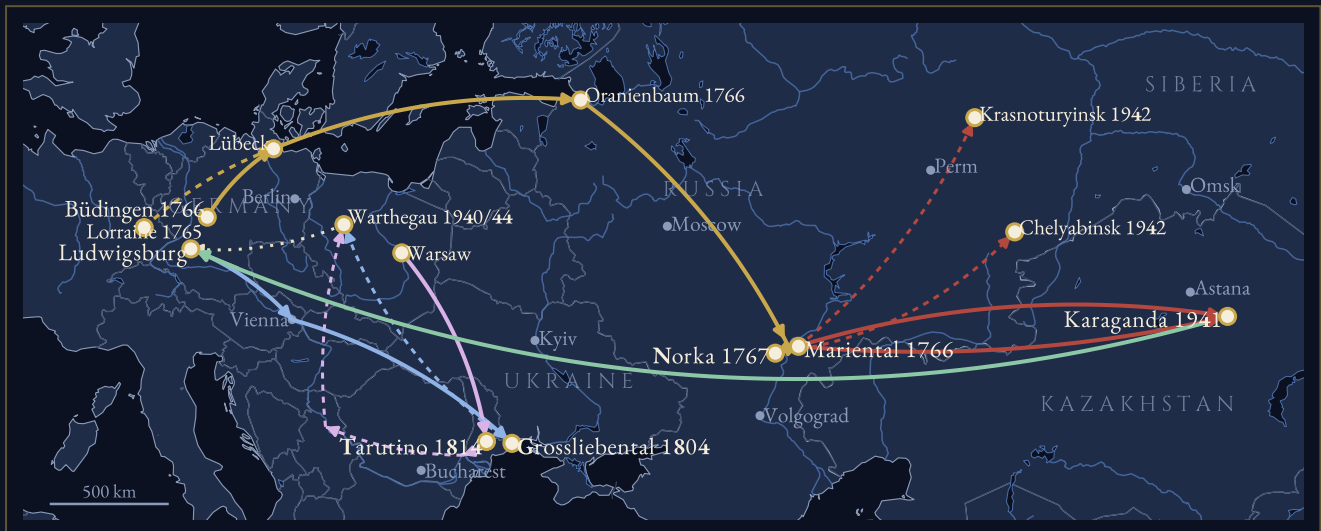
LINE	ORIGIN	SETTLEMENT	PATH
Schäfer	Isenburg territories, Wetterau; assembly point Büdingen 1766	Norka on the Berge side of the Volga, founded 1767, Reformed	1941 Karaganda, 1942 labor army, 1989 Ludwigsburg
Hoffmann	Lorraine; the colony was settled from Lorraine and Bavaria	Mariental on the Wiesenseite of the Volga, founded 1766, Catholic	1941 Karaganda, 1942 labor army
Bauer	Württemberg, village open	Grossliebental near Odessa, founded 1804, Lutheran	1944 trek to the Warthegau, 1945 flight to Württemberg
Wagner	Prussia via the Duchy of Warsaw	Tarutino in Bessarabia, founded 1814, Lutheran	1940 resettlement, 1941 Warthegau, 1945 flight to Württemberg

Persons marked with an asterisk are fictitious. This document is a sample: the Schäfer*, Hoffmann*, Bauer* and Wagner* families are invented, while all statements on colonies, sources, places, events and figures are real and documented. A report for your family ends with the generation born in the 1920s; younger relatives are not named with dates.

MAP

THE ROUTES OF THE FOUR FAMILIES

Four departures, three paths of persecution, one place of arrival. Two lines came via the Volga and Kazakhstan, two via the Black Sea, the Warthegau and the flight of 1945. All four end in Ludwigsburg.



- Schäfer 1766/67: Büdingen, Lübeck, Oranienbaum, Norka
 - - - Hoffmann 1765/66: Lorraine, Lübeck, Mariental
— Bauer 1804: Württemberg, Grossliebental
 — Wagner 1814: Warsaw, Tarutino
— Deportation 1941 to Karaganda
 - - - Labor army 1942
 - - - Resettlement 1940 via the Danube
- - - Trek 1944
 - - - Flight 1945
— Resettlement to Germany 1989

Solid lines are documented; dashed lines show a route documented only at its start and end. Borders as of today, place names in the family's spelling.

THE STATIONS

PLACE	TODAY	MEANING FOR THE FAMILY
Büdingen	Wetterau district, Hesse	Assembly point of the Schäfer line, 1766
Norka	Nekrasovo, Saratov oblast	Home of the Schäfer line 1767 to 1941
Mariental	Sovetskoye, Saratov oblast	Home of the Hoffmann line 1766 to 1941
Grossliebental	Velykodolynske near Odessa	Home of the Bauer line 1804 to 1944
Tarutino	Bessarabske, Odessa oblast	Home of the Wagner line 1814 to 1940
Warthegau	Greater Poland, annexed in 1939	Settlement 1941 and 1944, flight in January 1945
Karaganda	Kazakhstan	Place of exile of the Schäfer and Hoffmann lines from 1941
Ludwigsburg	Baden Württemberg	Arrival 1945 and 1989, marriage of the parents

CHAPTER I · SCHÄFER LINE

NORKA ON THE BERGSEITE

The Schäfer line begins with a list: 218 households that reached the Norka river in August 1767. The name appears there four times, each time with the origin Isenburg.

In 1766 Büdingen in the Wetterau was one of the most important assembly points of the emigration to the Volga; in St. Mary's Church 375 colonist couples were married between 24 February and 8 July before the treks set out for Lübeck.⁵ Most of the later Norka settlers reached Oranienbaum on 19 and 28 July 1766, swore the oath of allegiance and traveled via Saint Petersburg, overland and by river, wintering on the way, to Saratov.^{2 6} On 15 August 1767 Norka was founded as a crown colony, with 218 households and 738 persons, 753 according to other sources; the congregation was Reformed.^{2 4} In the founding list the name Schäfer appears four times, each from Isenburg: Johannes and Henriette Julianna Schäfer (no. 22), Apollonia Schäfer from Wolf (no. 37), Margaretha Schäfer (no. 80) and Johann Heinrich Schäfer from Burgbracht (no. 191a).^{2 3}

Norka grew to 1,662 inhabitants in 1798 and 14,236 in 1912; the wooden church was built in 1822, from 1875 the first families left for America, and the famine of 1921 halved the village.^{2 4} The family knows its line back to Konrad Schäfer*, born about 1845 in Norka. The chain between 1767 and 1845 can be closed with the 1798 census and the church books; it is not yet part of this report.¹⁹

- I **Konrad Schäfer*** * about 1845 Norka, † 1911 Norka
The first of the line whom the family knows by name. Farmer.
- II **Johann Georg Schäfer*** * 1878 Norka, † 1944 Karaganda region
Married to Katharina Elisabeth Krieger* (1882 to 1958), also from Norka. Died in the special settlement.
- III **Heinrich Schäfer*** * 1912 Norka, † 1979 Karaganda
The grandfather. Deported 1941, labor army in Chelyabinsk 1942 to 1946, married Maria Hoffmann* in 1947.

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED	Founding and development of the colony; four Schäfer entries in the list of 1767 with origin Isenburg, Wolf and Burgbracht confirmed; birth of Heinrich Schäfer* in Norka in 1912. ^{1 2 3 4}
PROBABLE	Descent from one of the two entries with a man of this name, no. 22 or no. 191a. ²
OPEN	The generations between 1767 and Konrad Schäfer*, and with them which of the two entries is the root.

CHAPTER II · HOFFMANN LINE

MARIENTAL ON THE WIESENSEITE

A Catholic colony from Lorraine and Bavaria, a raid from the steppe, a stone church of 1834. The Hoffmann line leads to the eastern bank of the Volga.

Mariental was founded on 16 June 1766 on the Great Karaman, not by the crown but by the recruiters Le Roy and Pictet, who had enlisted 82 families from Lorraine and Bavaria; according to the first settlers list some also came from the Electorate of Mainz, the Palatinate and Prussia.⁷ With the decree of 26 February 1768 the colony received the Russian name Tonkoshurovka, after a Ukrainian named Tonkoshura who had lived on the site.⁷ In 1774 Kazakh horsemen, called Kirghiz in the sources, raided the village; in 1773 the naturalist Pallas had visited the colony, and in 1837 the future Tsar Alexander II came.⁷

The congregation was and remained Catholic, seat of the Tonkoshurovka parish from 1767. Two wooden churches were followed in 1834 by the stone church, 51 meters long with a bell tower of 32 meters, burnt out in the night to 15 January 2001.⁷ From 1922 Mariental was the seat of a canton of the Volga Republic, which counted 26,700 inhabitants in 1926; in the famine year 1922 the canton recorded 536 births against 1,709 deaths from hunger.⁸ The village itself had 4,104 inhabitants in 1926.⁷ After the deportation it was renamed Sovetskoye on 5 June 1942.⁷

The Hoffmann* family can be traced in Mariental from Peter Hoffmann*, born about 1860.¹ His son Josef* married Anna Maria Weber* from the neighboring village in 1913; their daughter Maria*, born in 1921, is the grandmother of the line.¹

- I **Peter Hoffmann*** * about 1860 Mariental, † 1919 Mariental
Farmer. The earliest ancestor of the line known by name.
- II **Josef Hoffmann*** * 1889 Mariental, † 1942 Krasnoturyinsk
Married Anna Maria Weber* (1893 to 1969) in 1913. Died in the labor army in the northern Urals.
- III **Maria Hoffmann*** * 1921 Mariental, † 2004 Ludwigsburg
The grandmother. To Karaganda in 1941, married Heinrich Schäfer* in 1947, Ludwigsburg 1989.

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED	Founding, denomination, church, canton and population of the colony. ^{7 8} Birth of Maria Hoffmann* in Mariental in 1921. ¹
PROBABLE	Origin in of the line in Lorraine, the main origin of the founding families. ⁷
OPEN	The family's entry in the first settlers list of 1766; the generations before Peter Hoffmann*.

CHAPTER III · BAUER LINE

GROSSLIEBENTAL ON THE BLACK SEA

The Bauer line does not come from the Volga. It comes from Grossliebental, the main village of the Liebental colonies near Odessa, and went west in 1944.

A ukase of 17 October 1803 instructed the Duc de Richelieu to buy land for German settlers near Odessa; in spring 1804 Grossliebental and Kleinliebental were founded as the first colonies of the district.⁹ The settlers came mainly from Württemberg, others from Prussia, Baden, the Rhineland and Alsace; Grossliebental was Lutheran.⁹ The Liebental district comprised eleven colonies; it counted 2,500 inhabitants in 1806, 11,902 in 1859 and 13,309 in 1905.⁹

Grossliebental was the center: central school, girls' school, hospital, orphanage, volost court, annual May fairs, and from 1906 a tram to Lustdorf on the sea.⁹ The church was expropriated after the revolution and later converted into an Orthodox church.⁹ Today the town is called Velykodolynske and has about 13,300 inhabitants.⁹

COLONY OF THE LIEBENTAL DISTRICT	FOUNDED
Grossliebental, Kleinliebental, Josefstal	1804
Lustdorf, Alexanderhilf, Neuburg, Mariental, Peterstal, Franzfeld	1805
Freudental	1806
Güldendorf	1829

Christian Bauer*, born 1875 in Grossliebental, was arrested in 1937; his fate is unknown, and the family never received a notice.¹ His wife Magdalena* and their son Friedrich*, born 1908, stayed in the village until the Volksdeutsche Mittelstelle, the Nazi agency for ethnic Germans abroad, ordered the departure in March 1944.^{1 12}

I Christian Bauer* * 1875 Grossliebental, arrested 1937

Farmer. Married to Magdalena Ritter* (1879 to 1951). Fate after the arrest open.

II Friedrich Bauer* * 1908 Grossliebental, † 1988 Ludwigsburg

The grandfather. Trek to the Warthegau 1944, naturalization, flight January 1945, married Lydia Wagner* in 1946.

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED

Founding, origin of the settlers, denomination and development of the colony and the district.⁹ Birth of Friedrich Bauer* in Grossliebental in 1908; naturalization 1944.¹

PROBABLE

Origin of the line in Württemberg, the main origin of the Grossliebental settlers.⁹

OPEN

The home village; the arrest of Christian Bauer* in 1937 and his place of death (NKVD files, rehabilitation files in Ukraine).

CHAPTER IV · WAGNER LINE

TARUTINO IN BESSARABIA

The fourth line spoke Low German. It comes from Tarutino, the center of the Bessarabian Germans, and in 1940 it was the first of all to leave.

Tarutino was founded in 1814 by 136 families, as one of the first three German colonies in Bessarabia.¹⁰ They were “Warsaw colonists”: Germans who had previously settled in the Duchy of Warsaw, some 500 people from Prussia, 250 from Prussian Poland, 90 from Mecklenburg and only about 70 from Württemberg; hence Low German was spoken in the village.¹⁰ The settlement authority first called the place Elisabeth; the later name recalls the battle of Tarutino of 18 October 1812.¹⁰

From 1826 Tarutino held a weekly market, in 1878 a girls’ lyceum followed and in 1906 a boys’ grammar school; together with Sarata and Arzis it was one of the three centers of the Bessarabian Germans.¹⁰ In 1930 the village had 3,482 German and 2,313 other inhabitants, in 1940 3,746 Germans.¹⁰ Today the town is called Bessarabske, from 1940 to 2024 Tarutyne.¹⁰

Wilhelm Wagner*, born 1880 in Tarutino, farmer and carter, married Emilie Kühn* in 1905; their youngest daughter Lydia* was born in 1919.¹ On 5 September 1940 Germany and the Soviet Union signed the resettlement agreement in Moscow; between 18 September and 23 October 1940 about 93,000 Bessarabian Germans left the country, from 22 September on Danube ships from Galați to Semlin and Prahovo and from there by train to the camps.¹¹

- I **Wilhelm Wagner*** * 1880 Tarutino, † 1952 Ludwigsburg
Farmer and carter. Married Emilie Kühn* (1884 to 1960) in 1905. Resettlement 1940, Warthegau 1941, Württemberg 1945.
- II **Lydia Wagner*** * 1919 Tarutino, † 1998 Ludwigsburg
The grandmother. Met Friedrich Bauer* in the Warthegau in 1944, married in Ludwigsburg in 1946.

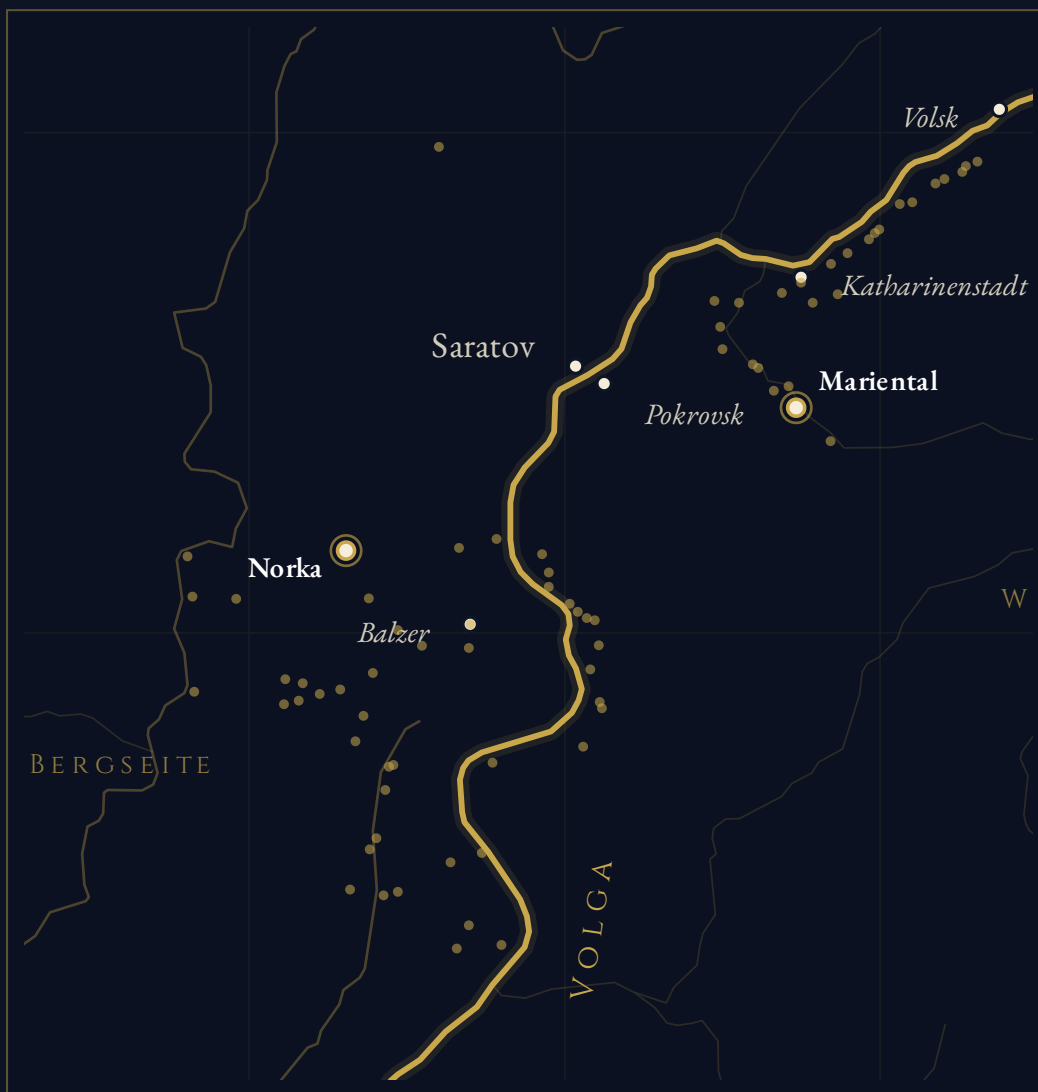
FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED	Founding, origin of the founders, development and population of the colony; agreement, period and scale of the 1940 resettlement. ^{10 11} Birth of Lydia Wagner* in Tarutino in 1919. ¹
PROBABLE	Origin of the line in Prussia via the Duchy of Warsaw, as with most founding families. ¹⁰
OPEN	The family’s entry in the founders list of 1814; the camp of 1940/41 and the place of settlement in the Warthegau (files of the Immigration Central Office). ¹³

MAP

NORKA AND MARIENTAL ON THE VOLGA

Bergseite and Wiesenseite: Norka lies in the hill country west of the river, Mariental on the Great Karaman in the flatland to the east, about 100 kilometers apart as the crow flies.



The Volga between Volsk and Kamysbin with the mother colonies whose location is secured. Highlighted: Norka, home of the Schäfer line, and Mariental, home of the Hoffmann line.

1941: DEPORTATION AND LABOR ARMY

A single sheet of paper ended 175 years on the Volga. Two lines that would never have met there came together in Kazakhstan.

On 28 August 1941 the Presidium of the Supreme Soviet issued the decree on the resettlement of the Germans living in the Volga districts; between 3 and 20 September 1941 the colonies were emptied. By 25 December 1941 the authorities had registered 894,626 deported Germans, 374,717 of them from the Volga Republic.¹⁴ The Schäfer* family from Norka and the Hoffmann* family from Mariental were both sent to the Karaganda region, to villages about 40 kilometers apart.¹

On 10 January 1942 the State Defense Committee ordered the mobilization of German men aged 17 to 50 into the labor army; on 14 February it was extended to the Germans who had not been deported, and on 7 October 1942 to men aged 15 to 55 and women aged 16 to 45.¹⁵ Just over 350,000 people passed through the labor army; about 150,000 died as a result of deportation and forced labor.¹⁵

Heinrich Schäfer* Chelyabinsk, 1942 to 1946

Construction of the metallurgical combine. Returned to Karaganda in 1946.

Josef Hoffmann* Krasnoturyinsk, † 1942

Bogoslovlag in the northern Urals, construction of the aluminum plant. Died in the first winter.

Those who survived remained special settlers under komendatura supervision: monthly registration, no leaving the place. Heinrich Schäfer* and Maria Hoffmann* married in Karaganda in 1947.¹ The supervision ended on 13 December 1955, but the right to return home did not come with it; only the decree of 29 August 1964 withdrew the accusations of 1941 as sweeping and unfounded, and only that of 3 November 1972 lifted the restrictions on residence.¹⁶ In 1959 Kazakhstan counted 659,751 Germans, in 1989 957,518.¹⁷

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED Decree, deportation figures and resolutions on the labor army; decrees of 1955, 1964 and 1972.^{14 15 16} Marriage in Karaganda in 1947.¹

PROBABLE Chelyabinsk as Heinrich Schäfer's* place of service and Krasnoturyinsk as Josef Hoffmann's* place of death, as remembered by the family.¹

OPEN Transport lists and komendatura files of the families; Josef Hoffmann's* death record; certificates of rehabilitation.

CHAPTER VI · BAUER AND WAGNER LINES

TREK AND FLIGHT: 1940 TO 1945

The Wagner line left by ship in 1940, the Bauer line by horse cart in 1944. They met in the Warthegau and fled together in January 1945.

1940. The resettlers from Bessarabia were taken to some 800 camps of the Volksdeutsche Mittelstelle in the Reich, in Austria and in the Protectorate; from November 1940 the commissions of the Immigration Central Office (EWZ) registered and naturalized them.^{11 13} In 1941 and 1942 they were settled roughly half in the Warthegau and half in Danzig West Prussia, on farms whose Polish owners had been expelled.¹¹ The Wagner* family received a farm in the Warthegau in 1941.¹

1944. When the front came back, the Volksdeutsche Mittelstelle took the Germans from the Odessa region westward: on 14 March 1944 the first village received the order to leave, and by 28 March the last had left their homes. In two treks, the northern and the southern, about 228,000 people reached the Warthegau after some three months.¹² The Immigration Central Office naturalized them; its files, with dates of birth, parents, siblings and a photograph, are held today in the German Federal Archives.¹³ Friedrich Bauer* and his mother arrived in July 1944; his naturalization notice of August 1944 is the oldest document in the family's possession.¹

1945. In January 1945 the Soviet offensive reached the Warthegau. Those who got through to the west stayed; those overtaken by the Red Army were sent back to the Soviet Union: more than 200,000 Black Sea Germans, by some estimates up to 280,000, were repatriated in 1945 and 1946.¹² The Bauer* and Wagner* families fled with the same trek and reached Württemberg in April 1945. Friedrich Bauer* and Lydia Wagner* married in Ludwigsburg in 1946.¹

FIGURE	WHAT IT MEANS
about 93,000	Bessarabian Germans resettled from 18 September to 23 October 1940 ¹¹
about 228,000	Black Sea Germans brought to the Warthegau in treks in 1944 ¹²
over 200,000	of them repatriated to the Soviet Union in 1945 and 1946, estimates up to 280,000 ¹²
9,383	file units of the Immigration Central Office in the Federal Archives, record group R 69 ¹³

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED	Resettlement 1940, camps, naturalization and settlement; trek of 1944 with dates and figures; repatriation 1945/46. ^{11 12 13} Naturalization of Friedrich Bauer* in 1944; marriage in Ludwigsburg in 1946. ¹
PROBABLE	The Wagner* family's place of settlement in the Warthegau and the route of the 1945 trek, as remembered by the family. ¹
OPEN	Naturalization files of both families in the Berlin Document Center collection; camp index cards of 1940/41. ¹³

TIMELINE

FROM BÜDINGEN TO LUDWIGSBURG



CHAPTER VII · ALL LINES

TWO ARRIVALS IN LUDWIGSBURG

One half of the family came in 1945 with the trek, the other in 1989 with an admission notice. That the lines met at all is owed to a town in Württemberg.

Many Bessarabian and Black Sea Germans who reached the western zones in 1945 found a new home in Württemberg, where some of their ancestors had set out 150 years earlier.¹¹ Friedrich and Lydia Bauer* found work in Ludwigsburg; their daughter, the client's mother, was born there.¹

For the lines in Kazakhstan the way opened only with perestroika. In 1987 14,488 resettlers came from the Soviet Union, in 1989 98,134, in 1994 the most with 213,214; from 1950 to 2020 there were 2,407,765 people in all.¹⁸ Maria Schäfer*, née Hoffmann, emigrated to Germany in 1989 with her children and grandchildren and was assigned to Ludwigsburg, where relatives from Norka had lived since 1977.¹ Her son, the client's father, married the Bauer* family's daughter in 1992.¹

THE GRANDPARENTS' GENERATION

Heinrich Schäfer* 1912 Norka, 1979 Karaganda
Labor army, miner in Karaganda.

Maria Schäfer* née Hoffmann 1921 Mariental,
2004 Ludwigsburg
Resettlement 1989.

Friedrich Bauer* 1908 Grossliebental, 1988
Ludwigsburg
Trek 1944, flight 1945.

Lydia Bauer* née Wagner 1919 Tarutino, 1998
Ludwigsburg
Resettlement 1940, flight 1945.

Four birthplaces in what are today two countries, Russia and Ukraine; four paths, one place of death for three of them. The grandchildren grew up in Ludwigsburg; their grandparents' records lie in Saratov, Odessa, the Federal Archives and Karaganda.

FINDINGS

DOCUMENTED Resettler figures; admission of the Schäfer* family in 1989; marriage of the parents in Ludwigsburg in 1992.^{1 18}

PROBABLE The assignment to Ludwigsburg because of the relatives from Norka who had resettled in 1977.¹

OPEN Admission file of 1989 (Federal Office of Administration), exit file in Karaganda.

RESULTS

WHAT THIS REPORT ESTABLISHES

Origin of the Schäfer line documented

Norka on the Bergseite, in the founding list of 1767 with four entries from Isenburg; Wolf and Burgbracht as confirmed places of origin.

Origin of the Hoffmann line documented for the colony

Mariental on the Wiesenseite, Catholic, founded 1766 from Lorraine and Bavaria; the home village is open.

Origin of the Bauer line documented for the colony

Grossliebental near Odessa, founded 1804, Lutheran, mainly from Württemberg; the village is open.

Origin of the Wagner line documented for the colony

Tarutino in Bessarabia, founded 1814 by Warsaw colonists from Prussia; the village is open.

The persecution documented

Deportation 1941 and labor army for Schäfer and Hoffmann; resettlement 1940 for Wagner, trek 1944 for Bauer, flight 1945 for both.

How the lines connect documented

Marriage Schäfer and Hoffmann 1947 in Karaganda, marriage Bauer and Wagner 1946 in Ludwigsburg, marriage of the parents 1992 in Ludwigsburg.

OPEN LEADS

Six questions cannot be answered from the published sources, but they can be with a record. For each, this shows where it is held. This is the starting point for individual research.

QUESTION	SOURCE
Does the family descend from no. 22 or no. 191a of the 1767 list?	1798 census of Norka, published ¹⁹
Which Isenburg village did the household come from?	Büdingen marriage register 1766, church books of the Wetterau, via Archion ⁵
Is the Hoffmann* family in the first settlers list of Mariental?	First settlers lists after Pleve ³ , 1798 census ¹⁹
What happened to Christian Bauer* after 1937?	State Archive of the Odessa region, NKVD files; rehabilitation files
What do the naturalization files of 1940 and 1944 contain?	Federal Archives, Berlin Document Center collection, files of the Immigration Central Office ¹³
Where did Josef Hoffmann* die, and where are the komendatura files?	Archive of the Sverdlovsk region (Bogoslovlag); State Archive of the Karaganda region

APPENDIX

SOURCES

1. Documents and information from the Schäfer* family (sample): birth and marriage certificates, naturalization notice 1944, admission notice 1989, recollections and photographs on the Schäfer, Hoffmann, Bauer and Wagner lines.
2. norkarussia.info, Norka, a German Colony in Russia (Steve Schreiber): Founders (households of 1767, origin from the 1766 ship lists and the 1767 census, confirmed places from church and civil records), Founding of Norka, Population, Immigration, Famine 1921 to 1924; accessed September 2026.
3. Igor Pleve: Einwanderung in das Wolgagebiet 1764 bis 1767. Göttinger Arbeitskreis, several volumes from 1999 (first settlers lists of the mother colonies).
4. Information system on the settlements of the Germans in Russia, siedlung.rusdeutsch.ru, entry Norka; accessed September 2026.
5. Klaus Peter Decker: Büdingen als Sammelplatz der Auswanderung an die Wolga 1766. Büdingen 2009.
6. Kulberg lists: Igor Pleve, Lists of Colonists to Russia in 1766, Saratov 2010; Andreas Idt and Georg Rauschenbach, Die Kuhlberg Listen, Moscow 2024; overview at volgagermans.org.
7. Lexikon der Wolgadeutschen, lexikon.wolgadeutsche.net, article Mariental; Volga German Institute, colony of Mariental; population figures for 1922 and 1926 after Stumpp, as given in the wolgadeutsche.net forum; accessed September 2026.
8. Encyclopedia of the Germans in Russia, enc.rusdeutsch.eu, article Mariental canton; accessed September 2026.
9. Encyclopedia of the Germans in Russia, article Liebental colonist district; article “Großliebenthal”, German Wikipedia; Heimatverein Schwaikheim, Großliebental; accessed September 2026.
10. Bessarabiendeutscher Verein, home community Tarutino (after Albert Kern, Heimatbuch Tarutino, 1976); articles “Bessarabiendeutsche” and “Tarutyne”, German Wikipedia; accessed September 2026.
11. Online Lexikon zur Kultur und Geschichte der Deutschen im östlichen Europa, articles Bessarabien and Umsiedlung; Kulturstiftung der deutschen Vertriebenen, timeline of the 1940 resettlement; Bundesinstitut für Kultur und Geschichte des östlichen Europa, Der Schicksalsweg der Bessarabiendeutschen.
12. Article “Schwarzmeerdeutsche”, German Wikipedia, section on the resettlement of 1944; Federal Agency for Civic Education, short dossier Wer sind die Russlanddeutschen (repatriation 1945/46); telex on the completion of the treks, 17 July 1944, recorded in the EHRI portal.
13. German Federal Archives, record group R 69 Einwandererzentralstelle Litzmannstadt, 9,383 file units, finding aid 2008; personal naturalization files in the Berlin Document Center collection.
14. Decree of the Presidium of the Supreme Soviet of the USSR of 28 August 1941; Landsmannschaft der Deutschen aus Russland, day of remembrance of the deportation, lmdr.de: 894,626 deportees by 25 December 1941, of them 374,717 from the Volga Republic, according to KGB figures.
15. Encyclopedia of the Germans in Russia, article Labor Army: resolutions of the State Defense Committee no. 1123 of 10 January 1942, no. 1281 of 14 February 1942 and no. 2383 of 7 October 1942; Federal Agency for Civic Education, Informationen zur politischen Bildung, Russlanddeutsche: just over 350,000 in the labor army, about 150,000 dead (after Viktor Krieger).
16. Decrees of 13 December 1955, 29 August 1964 and 3 November 1972; as presented by the Federal Agency for Civic Education and the Landsmannschaft der Deutschen aus Russland.
17. Soviet censuses of 1959 and 1989, Germans in the Kazakh SSR; according to the Deutsche Allgemeine Zeitung (Almaty) and English Wikipedia, Germans of Kazakhstan.
18. Federal Office of Administration (Bundesverwaltungsamt): (Spät)Aussiedler und ihre Angehörigen, time series 1950 to 2022; Federal Agency for Civic Education, facts and figures on resettlers.
19. Brent Alan Mai (ed.): 1798 Census of the German Colonies along the Volga, Lincoln 1999; The 1775 and 1798 Censuses of the German Colony on the Volga, Norka, AHSGR 1995.
20. Karl Stumpp: Die Auswanderung aus Deutschland nach Rußland in den Jahren 1763 bis 1862. Tübingen 1972.

Note. Personal details about the families are based on the family’s documents and information (source 1) and have not in every case been checked against original records. What has been checked carries a source number; what is open is stated in the findings and the open leads. In this sample the families are fictitious.

WOLGAWURZELN

RESEARCH FOR YOUR FAMILY

This document is a sample. An origin report or a family history for your own family begins with a free first assessment: you send the surname and, if known, the village or region, and you learn what can be found before any cost arises.

ORIGIN REPORT

39 € one time

- one surname
- assignment to the colony
- history of the colony
- the family's migration route
- PDF in 3 to 5 days

FAMILY HISTORY

69 € one time

- up to four surnames
- origin of every line
- a narrated history
- map and timeline
- PDF in 5 to 8 days

INDIVIDUAL RESEARCH

149 € for 3 hours

- ancestors with names and dates
- requests to archives in Germany and Russia
- report included
- further hours only after your approval

Both reports are also available as a printed photo book for 29 €, shipping within Germany included. All fees are final prices; no VAT is charged under § 19 UStG. Transcriptions of old handwriting are quoted after the scans have been reviewed.

HOW IT WORKS

1 · FIRST ASSESSMENT

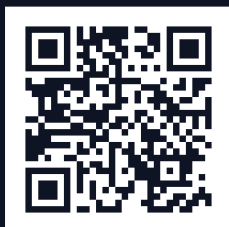
Surname and, if known, village or region, by WhatsApp or email. Reply usually within 24 hours: what can be found, which route makes sense, what it costs. Free of charge.

2 · ORDER

Order with the surname and what you already know. Before the research begins, names and details are reviewed together so that nothing fails because of a spelling variant.

3 · DELIVERY

The report arrives as a PDF with sources, map and timeline. The invoice comes with the report. On request also printed as a photo book.



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Replies usually within 24 hours, in German, Russian or English.